



## CHERRY BLOSSOM, JAPAN

Spring is celebrated in Japan with the arrival of the cherry blossom, a symbol of hope and renewal. Japanese people get together to marvel at these brilliant, fragrant displays of colour. It is thought that the blossoms help us to remember that lives should be lived to the full.



**BLOSSOMING SOUTH TO NORTH**  
The cherry blossom season begins in Okinawa in January and moves northwards to Kyoto and Tokyo at the end of March.

## THE GREAT WALL OF CHINA

Built to protect against raids from the north, the Great Wall of China is made up of different sections, built by various Chinese dynasties. The longest structure ever built, much of the wall was constructed in the 14th century during the Ming Dynasty.



**BIG BUILD**  
The outside of the wall was built with stones and fired bricks and the inside filled with stones and mud. Sections were up to 7.5 m (25 ft) wide and stretched for thousands of kilometres.

## MOUNT EVEREST, NEPAL

At 8,848 m (29,029 ft) high, this is the highest mountain in the world. In 1953 climbers Edmund Hillary from New Zealand and Nepalese Sherpa Tenzing Norgay became the first people to reach the summit of Everest.



**TOUGH CLIMB**  
To date, more than 4,000 people have climbed Mount Everest. Climbers have to face avalanches, freezing temperatures, storms, altitude sickness, and a lack of oxygen.

**NEW HEIGHTS**  
With the movement of tectonic plates, Everest continues to increase in height by approximately 4 mm (0.16 in) every year.

## ORANGUTANS, BORNEO

Borneo is one of only two remaining natural habitats for orangutans. An endangered species, they live in the tropical canopy, eating fruit and sleeping in nests made of branches.



**SWING TIME**  
Orangutans have long arms and a strong grip.

## FAST FACTS

More than half the world's population lives in Asia. The biggest cities are also found here.

- **AREA:**  
43,608,000 sq km (16,838,365 sq miles)
- **POPULATION:**  
4,426,683,000
- **NUMBER OF COUNTRIES:**  
49
- **LARGEST COUNTRY BY AREA:**  
Russian Federation 17,075,400 sq km (6,592,846 sq miles)
- **LARGEST COUNTRY BY POPULATION:**  
China 1,340,000,000
- **LARGEST CITY BY POPULATION:**  
Tokyo, Japan 38,000,000
- **HIGHEST POINT:**  
Mount Everest 8,848 m (29,029 ft)
- **LOWEST POINT:**  
Dead Sea, Israel -413 m (-1,378 ft)
- **LONGEST RIVER:**  
Yangtze, China 6,299 km (3,915 miles)